

Tower Research Capital - Limestone Data Challenge

Background

Limestone is one of the largest trading teams at Tower Research Capital LLC (“Tower”). At Limestone, we focus on solving some of the most challenging problems financial markets present.

Over the past several years, we have hosted an annual data challenge across campuses in India. This year, the Limestone Data Challenge is expanding globally. The challenge is designed to encourage creative problem-solving; participants are welcome to use any AI tools they have access to, provided their work is clearly documented.

This challenge is open to MIT students in the United States. In addition to being an engaging exercise, the challenge is intended to help participants demonstrate skills relevant to quantitative research roles.

The challenge will be conducted on Hackerrank and its rules and submission guidelines will be available on the hackerrank portal.

Acceptance of Terms

By submitting an entry to the challenge, each participant acknowledges that they have read, understand, and agree to be bound by all terms and conditions set forth below in this document.

Format, Timing, and Team Size

- The contest will run for **24 hours** on a specified date that will be communicated to registered participants in advance.
 - You have **24 hours** to complete the test. It will be open for a total window of **72 hours**.
 - Participants may compete **in teams of up to two (2)** people.
 - Registration is required via the provided form.
-

Awards, Selection, and Use of Submissions

- The **top two (2)** submissions (as determined by Tower) will be eligible for cash awards:
 - **1st Place: \$50,000**

- **2nd Place: \$25,000**
- In addition, there will be **two prizes of \$5,000 each** awarded to the top submission(s) submitted by participants in their **first or second year** of college (eligibility as determined by Tower).

Winner Selection: Winners will be selected by Tower in its **sole discretion**, based on criteria Tower deems appropriate for the challenge.

Use of Submissions: By submitting an entry, participants acknowledge that Tower may use, reproduce, modify, and/or distribute the submission **for any purpose, without compensation, and at no cost to Tower**. This does **not** restrict participants from continuing to use or build on their own submissions.

Results Notification

Tower will communicate the contest results to all participants **no later than April 30, 2026**.

Tax Notice

Receipt of a cash award may be subject to tax in the United States and/or other jurisdictions depending on a participant's circumstances. Participants are responsible for obtaining their own tax advice and for any applicable tax reporting or payment obligations.